



Ravi Kiran Achalla
Senior Manager II, Walmart

GENERAL INFORMATION

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Date Of Birth (D.O.B): 1985-07-15

Industry Experience

- Retail

Current role

- Senior Engineering Manager, Big Data

Skills

GenAI & Agentic AI

- LLM and RAG
- Google ADK (Agent Development Kit), GPT, Gemini
- FastAPI, Streamlit

Cloud & Big Data Platform

- GCP Cloud Platform (GCS, Dataproc, BigQuery)
- Azure IaaS & Terraform
- Spark, Hadoop, Hudi, Hive, Tez
- Cloud Cost Optimization

Data Strategy & Architecture

- Data Architecture, Data Modeling
- Data Strategy & Roadmap Planning
- Data Platform Engineering, Big Data Ecosystems
- Data Analytics & Science Enablement

Governance & Reporting

- Data Governance & Compliance
- Reporting & Data Visualization
- Data Catalog, Dataplex

Overview

- **Accomplished Senior Engineering Manager** with 15 years of progressive experience in architecting and leading high-scale **Data Engineering, Big Data, and Cloud Analytics** initiatives
- Proven expertise in translating business strategy into scalable data platforms, driving significant **cloud cost optimization** (up to **\$50M** annually) , and specializing in **Data Products, Agentic AI, and Generative AI**.
- Leads cross-functional teams up to 25 members, coaching talent, and establishing **Data Governance and Architecture** across complex enterprise environments.
- **Thought leader** recognized for integrating GenAI and Agentic AI to achieve more than **30% reduction in manual effort** for data engineering and support automation.

Professional experience

Senior Manager II – Data Engineering, Walmart (Nov 2023 - Present)

- **Spearheaded Cloud Cost Optimization** initiatives, transformed FinOps practices, resulting in a sustainable **\$50M** in annual cloud cost savings.
- **Led the development and adoption** of the **eCommerce 360 Data Product**, providing a consolidated customer journey view and driving a **\$50M** positive impact on product cost margin.
- **Architected and governed** the **Unified Data Analytics** solution across Walmart's tenants, defining architecture, compliance, security, and access policies for a **Peta-Scale GCP-based Data Lake** serving over **800+** internal users.
- **Automated Data Engineering and support** capabilities using **Agentic AI and GenAI**, achieving a scalable efficiency gain with **> 30% reduction in manual effort**.
- **Directed the creation** of a Data Analytics solution for **Global Supplier KPIs**, resulting in high supplier satisfaction and enabling **\$80M** in revenue generation through data monetization.
- **Defined and implemented** a 3-year **data strategy roadmap** focused on platformisation and GenAI integration, resulting in **20% efficiency** gains across International markets - Canada and Mexico.

Staff Data Engineer and Senior Manager I – Data Engineering, Walmart (Jun 2021 – Oct 2023)

- **Led the migration** of the Data Analytics platform from an on-premises Hadoop cluster to a modernized **GCP-based data platform**, developing an automated approach for **3000+** pipeline conversion and Airflow workflows
- **Initiated and managed** the team enhancing the "**eCommerce Fraud Detection**" application (**Custom ML solution**), which prevents **\$200M** worth of fraudulent transactions per year across International markets.
- **Directed the development** of the "Adjustment Management Tool" using GCP, Kafka, and Spark streaming, ensuring accurate real-time inventory and maintaining **OSA > 95%** across Walmart International stores.
- **Championed GCP Cloud Cost savings** project across Data Analytics, devising methods and implementing regular audits that achieved cloud cost savings of more than **\$10M**.
- **Developed and mentored** the Big Data Engineering team, fostering expertise in GCP tools and ensuring successful project delivery for ML and Data Science initiatives.

Senior Data Engineer – Data Engineering, Walmart (Feb 2018 – May 2021)

- Served as **Technical Lead** for designing and developing the on-premises Hadoop Data Analytics platform, creating a PySpark-based ingestion framework for real-time and batch processing.
- **Led data modeling and architecture** for the on-premises Hadoop Data Lake, personally designing and implementing **400+ data models** and pipelines using a semi-automated approach.
- Developed expertise in **SAP Hana** for building Data Analytics and reporting solutions leveraging Tableau.

Earlier Career (2009 – 2018)

- **Walmart (Feb 2015 – Jan 2018):** Led the technical development of the initial **on-premises Hadoop Data Lake**, integrating **IBM DataStage, Spark/PySpark, and Cassandra** to modernize ETL and Big Data capabilities, ultimately supporting **800+ critical data pipelines**.
- **ETL Technical Lead, Canadian Tire Corporation (Jul 2012 – Jan 2015):** Served as Technical Lead in

Programming & ETL

- Python, Pyspark, Scala
- IBM Datastage, Talend

Data Warehousing & NoSQL

- SAP Hana, Teradata, Oracle, Greenplum, SQL Server, Neo4j
- Apache Cassandra

Orchestration & Streaming

- Airflow, Automic, ControlM
- Kafka, Kafka Connect, Spark Streaming

Executive Leadership

- Team Leadership & Management (Scale, cross-functional, vendor teams)
- Budget Oversight & Financial Planning
- Coaching & Career Development
- Partnership & Stakeholder Management
- Executive Presentation

Patents

Metrics Definition Tool

<https://patents.google.com/patent/US11138241B2>

Education

B.Tech, CSE, KIITS, Bhubaneswar (8.5 CGPA), 2009

Certifications

- iLead (Walmart, IIMB)
- Agentic AI Advanced (Coursera)
- Systems Design and DSA (Algoexpert)
- Cassandra certification (Datastax)
- IBM Datastage (IBM)
- Red Hat Certified Linux Professional (Red Hat)

Awards

- Walmart - Excellence Award (2024, 2018, 2011)
- Spark Hackathon (2022)
- Walmart – Inspiring Innovation (2021)

the Centre of Excellence for ETL development (**IBM DataStage**), leading data model design and technical demonstrations for new Retail clients.

- **ETL Developer, Marks & Spencers (Nov 2009 – Jun 2012): Specialized in high-volume ETL Data Pipeline development**, utilizing **IBM DataStage** to lead and support **200+ production data pipelines** for a UK Retail giant, acquiring deep functional domain knowledge.